Unit 4: Civilisation

Reading: Voices from the past

Lesson 4-1
Book pages 37-39

💡 **Big idea:** We learn about great **ancient civilisations** (Egyptian, Sumerian, Roman, Greek, Mayan and **Majan** in Oman). In **Voices from the Past**, teenagers from different civilisations describe their lives, jobs, buildings and writing.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Match civilisations with pictures and facts
- Read texts and identify which civilisation each teenager is from
- Use new vocabulary about civilisation
- Discuss why it is important to study ancient civilisations

📖 Key words

civilisation حضارة	**ancient** قديم	**empire** إمبراطورية	**citizen** مواطن
archaeologist عالم آثار	**trade** يتاجر / تجارة	**society** مجتمع	**economy** اقتصاد
monument نصب تذكاري	**agriculture** زراعة	**cuneiform** الكتابة المسمارية	**hieroglyphics** الكتابة الهيروغليفية

Ancient civilisations

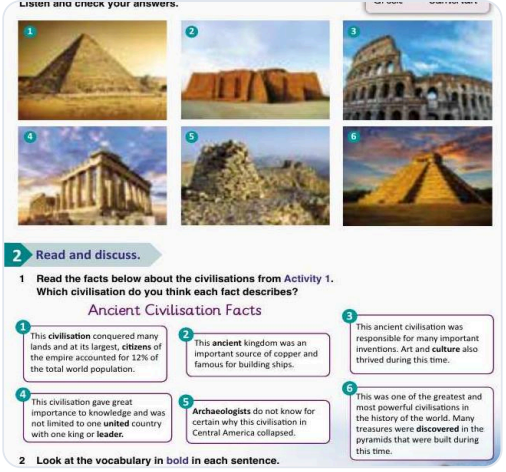
- **Roman**: conquered many lands, citizens were 12% of the world population
- **Majan** (Oman): an ancient kingdom famous for **copper** and building ships
- **Greek**: responsible for many inventions, art and culture
- **Egyptian**: one of the most powerful, famous for **pyramids**
- **Mayan**: archaeologists do not know why it collapsed in Central America

Voices from the past

- **Rome, 100 AD**: the Colosseum could seat 50,000 people
- **Majan, 950 BC**: Mubarak's father trades copper and has a fleet of dhows, sailing using the stars
- **Sumer, 2100 BC**: Iskur trains as an accountant, writes in **cuneiform** on clay tablets, the Great **Ziggurat** at Ur
- **Egypt, 1500 BC**: agriculture is the main industry, people read **hieroglyphics**

Why study ancient civilisations?

- To understand how people lived and worked
- To learn from their inventions and mistakes
- To be proud of our history, like Majan in Oman
- To protect historical sites


Listen and check your answers.

2 Read and discuss.

1 Read the facts below about the civilisations from Activity 1. Which civilisation do you think each fact describes?

Ancient Civilisation Facts

1 This **civilisation** conquered many lands and at its largest, **citizens** of the empire accounted for 12% of the total world population.

2 This **ancient** kingdom was an important source of copper and famous for building ships.

3 This ancient civilisation was responsible for many important inventions. Art and **culture** also thrived during this time.

4 This civilisation gave great importance to knowledge and was not limited to one **united** country with one king or **leader.**

5 **Archaeologists** do not know for certain why this civilisation in Central America collapsed.

6 This was one of the greatest and most powerful civilisations in the history of the world. Many treasures were **discovered** in the pyramids that were built during this time.

2 Look at the vocabulary in bold in each sentence.

Ancient civilisations: pictures and facts

✏️ Examples

Which civilisation was famous for copper and ships?

Answer: Majan (in Oman)

What are the two forms of writing in the texts?

Answer: cuneiform and hieroglyphics

Complete: A ___ is a large group of people who live together in an organised way.

Answer: society

⭐ Remember

- Write definitions of new words in a vocabulary notebook
- Look for dates and places to identify each civilisation

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ Majan was in Egypt. ✓ Majan was an ancient kingdom in Oman
- ✗ Romans wrote cuneiform. ✓ Sumerians invented cuneiform.

🧩 **Activity:** Role play: be a teenager from an ancient civilisation and let your group guess which one

✅ Check yourself

1. What was Majan famous for?
2. Who invented cuneiform?
3. Meaning of empire?

Answers: (1) copper and building ships ، (2) the Sumerians ، (3) a group of countries ruled by one ruler